



1831 Lewis chess pieces

Found on the Isle of Lewis, Scotland, and dating back to the 12th century, these medieval artefacts were displayed to the public for the first time in Edinburgh, Scotland. The game pieces were carved from walrus tusk and sperm whale tooth.

Also on this day

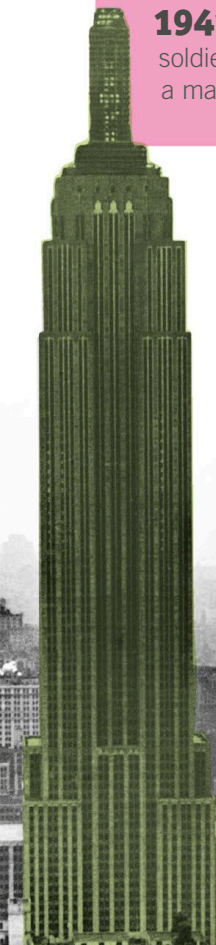
1814 The **Treaty of Fontainebleau** was signed in France, ending Napoleon Bonaparte's rule as emperor and forcing him to leave the country.

1941 French officer **Alain le Ray** became the first soldier to escape from Germany's Colditz Castle, a maximum-security prison, during World War II.

Impressive skyscraper

1931

In the USA, the construction of New York City's Empire State Building was finished, following 7 million hours of work carried out by 3,400 workers over just 410 days. It was the world's tallest building until 1972.



April

11



2010

Balloon flight

US pilot Jonathan Trappe spent 13 hours, 36 minutes, and 57 seconds flying over North Carolina, USA, using a cluster of 57 enormous helium balloons. During the overnight flight, he covered more than 175 km (109 miles) and reached a peak height of 2,278 m (7,474 ft).

Born this day

1991 **Thiago Alcântara**, Spanish footballer. He has played for many clubs, such as FC Barcelona, and also the Spanish national team.